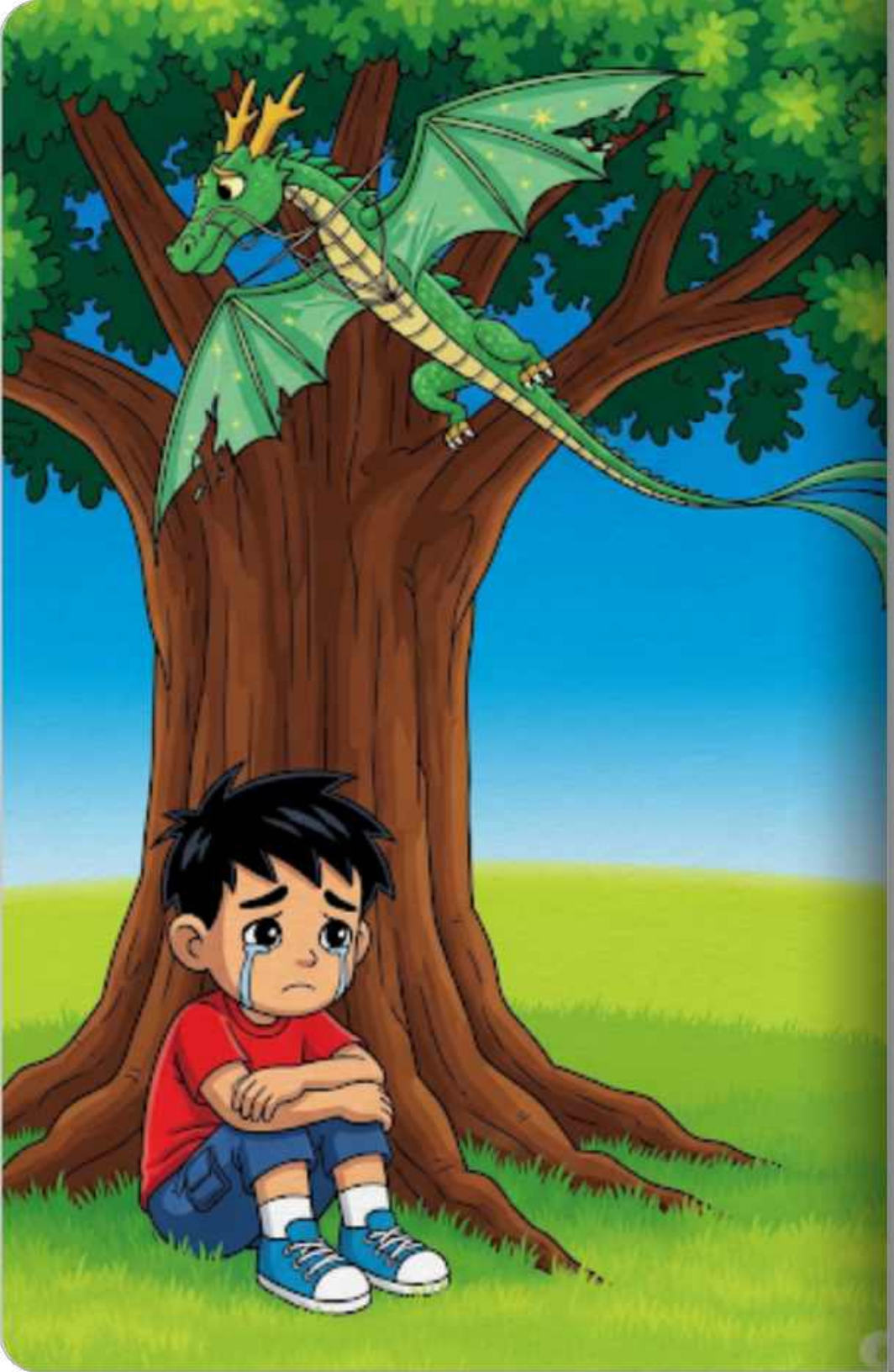
Hiro and the Rainy-Day Coat

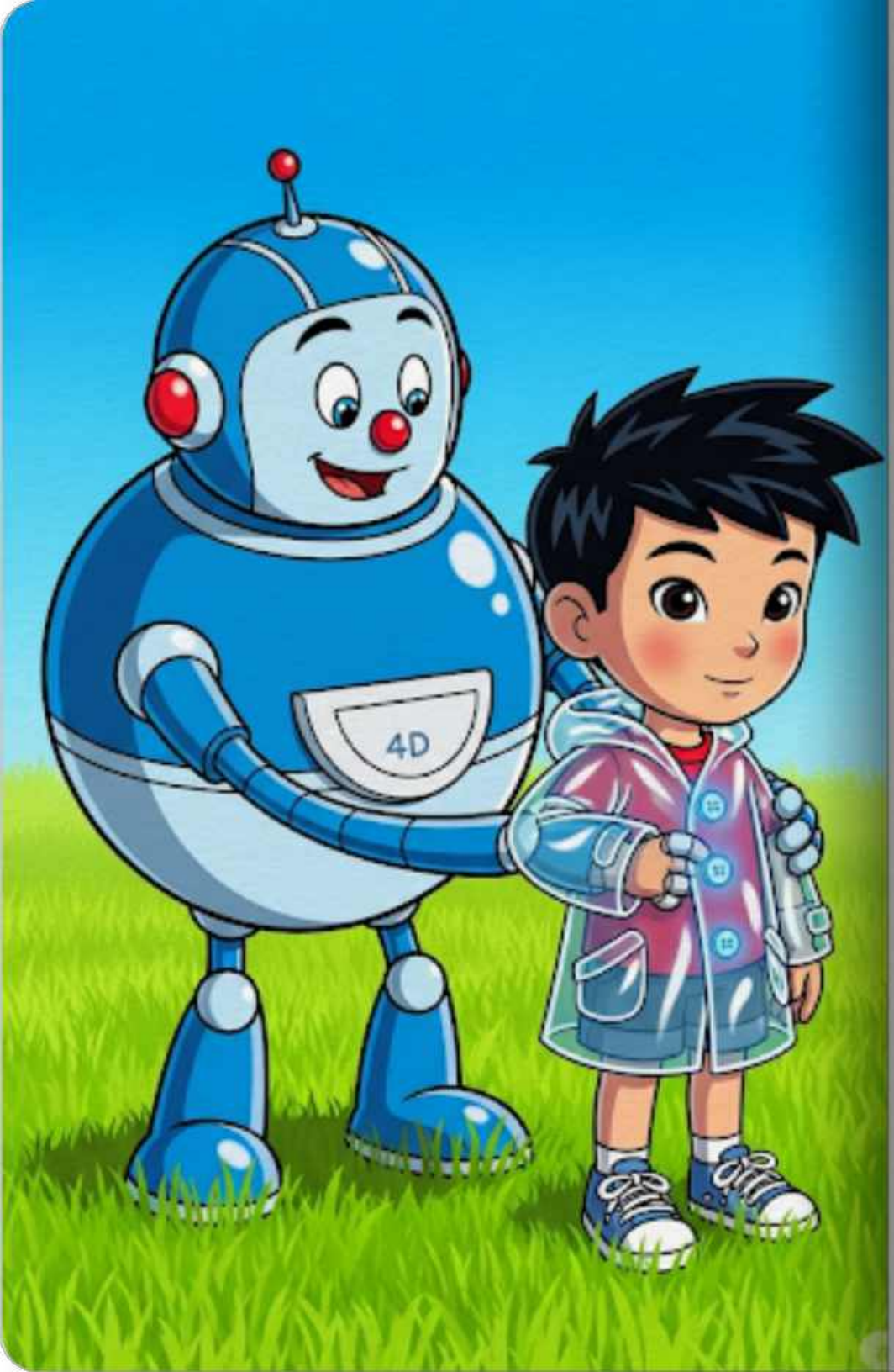
By Kshipra



Hiro sat under the giant oak tree in the park, his eyes filling with tears. High above, his favorite dragon kite was snagged on a sharp branch, its colorful paper wings torn and fluttering sadly in the wind. To Hiro, it felt like the end of the world. He didn't want to play; he just wanted to sit in the grass and be as still as a stone.

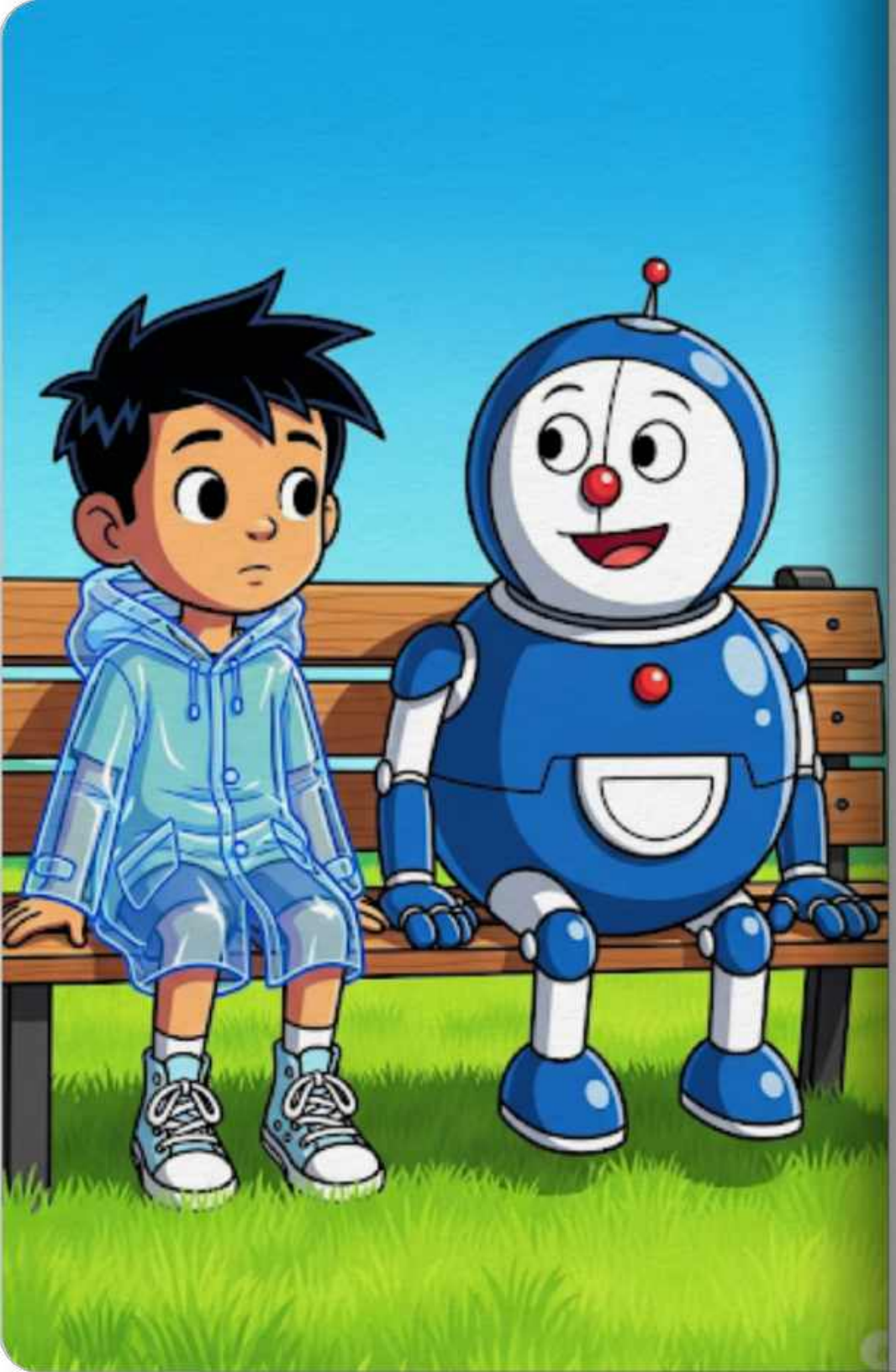
Suddenly, a familiar pop sounded behind him. Out of a swirling blue portal stepped Maru, the round, friendly robot from the 22nd century. Maru tilted his head, his mechanical eyes blinking with concern. "Why the long face, Hiro?" Maru asked softly, sitting down beside his friend. Hiro pointed at the tree, unable to find his words through the lumps in his throat.

"Ah, I see," Maru said, nodding slowly. "Sadness is heavy, isn't it? It feels like a big, gray cloud following you around." Maru reached into the 4D pocket on his tummy and rummaged around. "I have just the thing to help you understand this feeling. It's a futuristic gadget called the Emotion Raincoat!" He pulled out a shimmering, translucent coat that sparkled like a soap bubble.



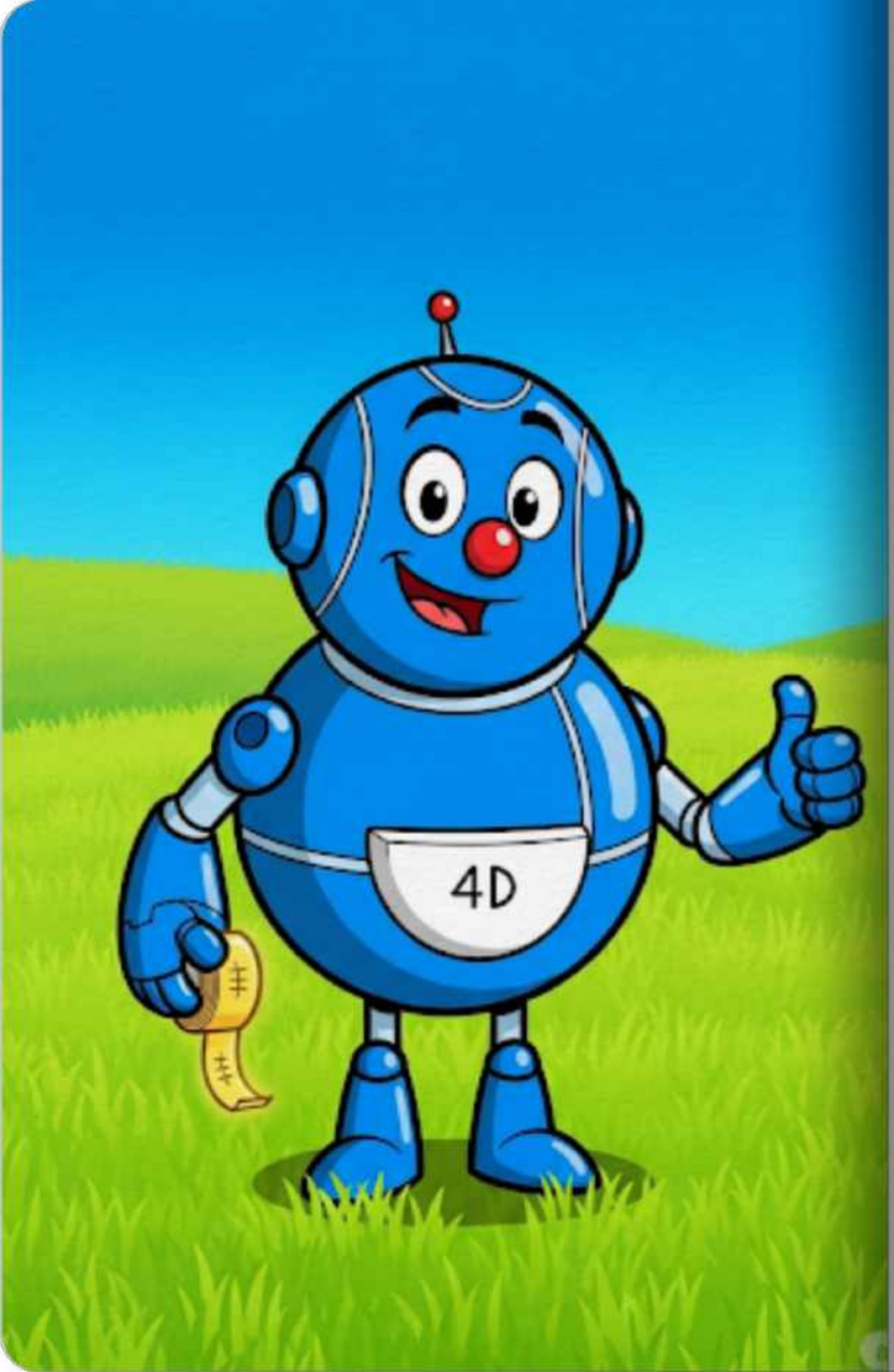
Maru helped Hiro slip the coat over his shoulders. As soon as the buttons were fastened, the coat turned a deep, ocean blue. "This coat shows us what's happening inside," Maru explained. "When you are sad, the coat catches the rain so you don't have to get soaked all by yourself. It's okay to let it be blue for a while."

Hiro looked at his sleeves. Inside the fabric of the coat, tiny, gentle raindrops began to fall, but Hiro stayed dry and warm. "Is the rain going to stop?" Hiro asked. Maru smiled. "Rain helps things grow, Hiro. Just like the flowers need water, our hearts sometimes need to cry to make room for new happy memories. Don't rush the sun; let the rain fall."



They sat together in silence for a long time. Maru didn't try to tell a joke or make Hiro laugh. He just stayed there, listening to the wind in the leaves and the distant sound of birds. Hiro felt the heaviness in his chest slowly start to soften, as if the raincoat was absorbing the weight of his torn kite.

Suddenly, the coat began to shimmer again. Above Hiro's head, a small, glowing bubble drifted out of the collar. Inside the bubble, Hiro saw a memory of the day he first got the kite, laughing as he ran through the meadow. "The coat is showing you why you're sad," Maru whispered. "You're sad because you loved that kite. And that's a beautiful thing to have."



Maru reached into his pocket once more. This time, he pulled out a roll of "Ever-Glow Mending Tape." "The rain has cleared the air," Maru said, winking. "Now that we've felt the sadness, we have the energy to try something new. Shall we rescue your dragon, Hiro? We can fix him together."

As they finished, the Emotion Raincoat turned a bright, sunny yellow and vanished into thin air. Hiro stood up, holding his mended kite high. He realized that while the sadness had felt like it would last forever, it was just a visitor